

Monday, October 10

We took Lloyd to the airport at 1:30. Michael and Cathy were there, waiting for Cathy to take the same plane home. Matthew walks with a bobbing action. He is busy with the carousel and luggage closets. Peter stood at a phone booth and talked on the receiver, first to himself, then with Matthew and me. Michael talked with a Soils Engineer professor, and Lloyd with a friend he had met in line.

We went to Muffin Break at Grosvenor Park Mall for coffee. Cheryl held Matthew while he slept. Peter wore a turtleneck with khaki green fall jacket that buttons cadet-like over the throat. We watched a young couple tugging on each other's arm and falling together into a puddle. Peter went home with Cheryl's parents.

Matthew wasn't happy. He stumbled around until he gave up walking and cried on the floor. He found Cheryl sewing and lay at her feet. As in the past, he was pinching at her panty hose. Today she sewed barelegged. He tried over and over but could get nothing between his fingers. She laughed and told him to scram. Eventually he unplugged her sewing machine.

We went to Cheryl's parents to pick up Peter. Matthew bashed his mouth on the coffee table, then sabotaged what Peter had built with Lego. Michael met us at our place for supper. I drove him back to Mom's and Dad's, then went by the school to pick up some tests. A house had just burned down near the school. The night was cold. The lawns are icy.

Cheryl's parents had brought Peter home. He went straight to bed and they visited for an hour. They talked about Lloyd's friends. When they left, I marked exams. Cheryl filled out Matthew's allergy form before his Wednesday appointment with Gerrard. We read before we went to bed.